MINISTER'S GUIDE · AFTER THE SESSION

Follow-Up Is Part of the Ministry

Loving follow-up and clear communication, with scripture for each point and an honest note where scripture is silent

Deliverance does not end when the session ends. Many of the people we pray with are lonely. Some are fighting thoughts of ending their life. If we minister to them and then disappear, we leave the work half done, and it helps far less than we may think. Follow-up is easy to overlook on both sides, so this guide treats it as part of the ministry itself.

How each point is supported: SCRIPTURE SAYS IT a verse speaks to it directly · SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE a clear principle, applied here · NO DIRECT VERSE practical wisdom; scripture doesn't address it

1 Why follow-up matters

The apostles went back

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Paul didn't treat a visit as finished. He returned to strengthen people, and when he couldn't go, he sent someone or wrote.

> *"Let's return now and visit our brothers in every city in which we proclaimed the word of the Lord, to see how they are doing."* Acts 15:36

> *"When I couldn't stand it any longer, [I] sent that I might know your faith, for fear that by any means the tempter had tempted you."* 1 Thess 3:5

An empty house is at risk

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

The enemy (Satan and his demons) looks for a way back in. A demon that has been cast out may try to return to a life that was swept clean but left empty. Follow-up helps the person stay filled with the Holy Spirit, the Word and godly fellowship.

> *"He finds it empty, swept, and put in order. Then he goes, and takes with himself seven other spirits more evil than he is."* Matt 12:44-45

Shepherds go after the one

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

God rebuked shepherds who left the weak and broken alone. Jesus describes a shepherd who goes looking until he finds the one.

> *"You haven't bound up that which was broken… You haven't sought that which was lost."* Ezek 34:4

> *"[He goes] after the one that was lost, until he found it."* Luke 15:4

Lonely people need people

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Many we pray with could say what David said in the cave. God's answer to loneliness usually comes through His people.

> *"There is no one who is concerned for me… No one cares for my soul."* Ps 142:4

> *"God sets the lonely in families."* Ps 68:6

> *"Woe to him who is alone when he falls, and doesn't have another to lift him up."* Eccl 4:10

God comforts through people

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Even Paul was lifted by someone showing up. Your visit, call or message can be the way God strengthens someone.

> *"He who comforts the lowly, God, comforted us by the coming of Titus."* 2 Cor 7:6

> *"Jonathan… went to David into the woods, and strengthened his hand in God."* 1 Sam 23:16

Love shows up in deed

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Saying "I'm here for you" at the end of a session is a word. Reaching out on Thursday is the deed.

> *"Let's not love in word only, or with the tongue only, but in deed and truth."* 1 John 3:18

> *"I was sick, and you visited me."* Matt 25:36

2 A simple follow-up rhythm

NO DIRECT VERSE FOR THE TIMING

Scripture gives the pattern of going back (Acts 15:36) but no schedule. The timing below is practical wisdom. Adjust it to the person and to how the Holy Spirit leads.



Session	Same day	Days 1-3	1 week	1 month	3 months +
Say plainly when and how you'll reach out	Short note: "I'm praying for you." Send written recap	First real check-in. Sleep, thoughts, anything returning?	Call or meet if you can. Review aftercare steps	How is the walk? Any new doors to close?	Connected to a local body of believers and friends

Between steps: pray for them by name, and send a verse now and then with "no reply needed"

The goal is not a minister they lean on forever. It is a person walking with Jesus, surrounded by His people.

3 When the person is in a dark place

Elijah had just seen fire fall from heaven. A day later he sat under a tree and asked God to let him die. Look at how God answered him. He didn't scold Elijah or quote a lesson at him. He met him step by step.



Our follow-up can follow the same order: show up gently, meet real needs, listen, remind them they're not alone, and connect them to others.

SCRIPTURE

SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

> *"He requested for himself that he might die… an angel touched him, and said to him, 'Arise and eat!'… 'because the journey is too great for you.'"* 1 Kings 19:4-7

> *"Don't harm yourself, for we are all here!"* Acts 16:28

> *"Rescue those who are being led away to death!"* Prov 24:11

> *"Encourage the faint-hearted; support the weak; be patient toward all."* 1 Thess 5:14

WHAT YOU CAN DO

- ☐ Take any mention of suicide seriously, even if it sounds offhand.
- ☐ Ask directly and kindly: "Are you having thoughts of ending your life?" Asking does not plant the idea; it opens the door to help.
- ☐ Listen more than you speak. Stay with them, in person or on the phone, until they are connected to help.
- ☐ Pray with them, and help them take authority over the enemy's lies in Jesus' name (Luke 10:19, John 10:10).
- ☐ Don't promise to keep it secret. Keep confidences (Prov 11:13), but never at the cost of someone's life.

988
CALL OR TEXT

Get urgent help alongside prayer

NO DIRECT VERSE · SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE

In the US, the person (or you, with them) can call or text **988**, the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, at any hour. If someone is in immediate danger, call **911**. Help them see that a doctor or counselor is not a lack of faith. Jesus Himself said, "Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick do" Luke 5:31, and "in the multitude of counselors there is victory" Prov 11:14. Scripture doesn't mention hotlines, of course; these verses give the principle.

IF THEY REPORT HEALING

Rejoice with them, and encourage them to let their doctor confirm it before they stop or change any medicine, treatment, or medical advice. Jesus sent the healed lepers to the priests to have it confirmed Luke 17:14.

4 Communicate clearly, before and after

Much of the silence ministers feel starts with unclear expectations. If the person doesn't know you'll reach out, or what you hope to hear, they may not know how to answer.

SCRIPTURE SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

> *"Write the vision, and make it plain on tablets, that he who runs may read it."* Hab 2:2

> *"Unless you uttered by the tongue words easy to understand, how would it be known what is spoken?"* 1 Cor 14:9

> *"Let your 'Yes' be 'Yes' and your 'No' be 'No.'"* Matt 5:37

> *"Let your speech always be with grace, seasoned with salt."* Col 4:6

> *"Let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak."* James 1:19

BEFORE THEY LEAVE, MAKE SURE THEY KNOW

- ☐ When you will reach out, and how (text, call, visit). Then do it on that day. If you say Thursday, it's Thursday.
- ☐ What you hope they'll tell you: how they're sleeping, their thoughts, and whether any old struggle is coming back.
- ☐ That a short reply is fine, and silence won't make you give up on them.
- ☐ Who to contact if things get hard before then, including 988.
- ☐ What was done in the session (who they forgave, what they renounced) and their aftercare steps, in writing (see *Walking It Out*).

Write messages that invite a real answer. NO DIRECT VERSE FOR WORDING PRINCIPLE: COL 4:6, PROV 12:25

EASY TO BRUSH OFF

"Hey, how are you?"

Usually gets "Good" or "Fine," which tells you nothing.

INVITES A REAL ANSWER

"Hi Sam, I've been praying for you since Tuesday. How have your evenings been since we prayed? Any of the old thoughts trying to come back? No pressure to write a lot. I'll check in again Friday."

Use their name, say you're praying, ask one or two specific questions, give permission to keep it short, and name the next time you'll reach out. "Anxiety in a man's heart weighs it down, but a kind word makes it glad." Prov 12:25

5 When they don't answer, or answer in one word

This is discouraging, and it's fine to admit it. You gave your time, your prayer and your heart, and you hear nothing, or only "fine." Jesus knew this feeling too.

SCRIPTURE SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

> *"Weren't the ten cleansed? But where are the nine?"* Luke 17:17

Only one in ten came back. Jesus noticed, and He still healed all ten.

> *"I will most gladly spend and be spent for your souls. If I love you more abundantly, am I loved the less?"* 2 Cor 12:15

> *"No one came to help me, but all left me. May it not be held against them."* 2 Tim 4:16

> *"Love… is not provoked, takes no account of evil… bears all things… endures all things."* 1 Cor 13:4-7

> *"Let's not be weary in doing good, for we will reap in due season, if we don't give up."* Gal 6:9

> *"I planted. Apollos watered. But God gave the increase."* 1 Cor 3:6



Rarely does it mean "you failed" or "I don't care."

SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE Shame makes people hide: "I was afraid… so I hid myself" Gen 3:10. NO DIRECT VERSE The rest of this chart is pastoral observation, not scripture.

WHAT TO DO NO DIRECT VERSE FOR THESE STEPS · PRINCIPLE: 1 COR 13:7, LUKE 15:4

- [ ] Keep a gentle rhythm. Don't stop at the first silence, and don't flood them either.
- [ ] Try another way: a call instead of a text, a short voicemail, or a card in the mail.
- [ ] Send something that needs no answer: a verse and "Praying for you today. No reply needed."
- [ ] After several quiet attempts, send one honest, loving message: "I'll keep praying for you. My door is always open." Never use guilt.
- [ ] If you have any concern for their safety and they've gone quiet, don't wait. Reach out to the emergency contact they gave on the intake form, or call for help.
- [ ] Measure your faithfulness by obedience, not by replies. God gives the increase.

6 Guard yourself and them

Point them to Jesus — SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

You are not their savior. Jesus is, and He is the friend who stays. Help them build a life in a local body of believers, not around you.

> *"Not forsaking our own assembling together… but exhorting one another."* Heb 10:25

Share the load — SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Build a small follow-up team so no one carries everyone alone.

> *"The thing is too heavy for you. You are not able to perform it yourself alone."* Ex 18:18

Keep it above reproach — SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE

Where you can, have same-gender teammates do ongoing follow-up, and avoid late-night private messaging patterns. Scripture gives the principle, not these exact rules.

> *"Having regard for honorable things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men."* 2 Cor 8:21

Rest and receive — SCRIPTURE SAYS IT

Every deliverance minister is also a recipient of deliverance ministry. Let others follow up with you, too.

> *"He withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed."* Luke 5:16

7 Where scripture stands on each point

POINT	SUPPORT	KEY VERSES
Going back to check on people	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT	Acts 15:36; Acts 14:21-22; 1 Thess 3:1-5
A delivered life must be filled, not left empty	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT	Matt 12:43-45; Luke 11:24-26
Caring for the lonely, weak and despairing	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT	Ps 68:6; Eccl 4:9-10; 1 Kings 19:4-8; Acts 16:28; 1 Thess 5:14
Speaking plainly and keeping your word	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT	Hab 2:2; 1 Cor 14:9; Matt 5:37; Col 4:6
Not giving up when love isn't returned	SCRIPTURE SAYS IT	Luke 17:15-18; 2 Cor 12:15; Gal 6:9; 1 Cor 13:4-7
Written follow-up (letters, messages)	SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE	The epistles themselves; 2 John 12; 3 John 13-14
Encouraging a doctor or counselor; calling 988 / 911	SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE	Luke 5:31; Prov 11:14; Prov 24:11 (no verse names these services)
Same-gender follow-up and messaging limits	SCRIPTURE PRINCIPLE	2 Cor 8:21
Follow-up timing (same day, 1-3 days, 1 week…)	NO DIRECT VERSE	Practical wisdom built on Acts 15:36
How to word a check-in message	NO DIRECT VERSE	Practical wisdom built on Col 4:6; Prov 12:25
What silence or "fine" usually means	NO DIRECT VERSE	Pastoral observation; Gen 3:10 shows shame leads to hiding
Asking directly about suicide does not plant the idea	NO DIRECT VERSE	Practical and clinical wisdom

"Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort; who comforts us in all our affliction, that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction." 2 Cor 1:3-4

Scripture quotations are from the World English Bible (public domain). Companion handout for recipients: *You Don't Walk This Alone*.